

BUILD AT WHU · SUPERTeam GERMANY · OCTOBER 2026

ProofPanel

Research studies that pay verified humans in seconds, from a budget locked on Solana.

1 · Budget locked

2 · Human verified

3 · Paid in seconds

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THE PROBLEM

The problem with paid online studies

BOTS

99.8%

of the time, an AI agent built to answer surveys went undetected. A fake response costs about 5 cents.

FEES

33–43%

is what Prolific adds on top of every reward: 33.3% for academics, 42.8% for companies.

SLOW PAY

21 days

can pass before a Prolific submission is approved. Cash-out is PayPal only, from £6 or \$6.

THE IDEA

A researcher locks the study budget on Solana. A verified human is paid seconds after the last answer.

No invoice, no approval queue, no minimum cash-out. Sign-in is an email address; the wallet is created in the background.

How ProofPanel works

STEP 1

Fund

The researcher creates a study and locks the full budget in USDC in a vault owned by the program.

STEP 2

Verify

A participant signs in by email, gets a wallet, and proves once with World ID that they are a person.

STEP 3

Answer

They take the survey. A one-time link ties their response to their payout, without their name.

STEP 4

Get paid

The program sends one reward to that wallet. The researcher sees results and exports them.

Checked before every payout: the link is unused, the completion code matches, the minimum time has passed, and a place is still free.

The role of Solana

Question	With a payment account	With Solana, as built
Is the money really there?	Trust the platform's word	The budget sits in a vault owned by the program. Anyone can look it up before they start.
Can someone be paid twice?	Only the platform's database says no	Each payout creates a receipt for that wallet. A second payout is rejected on-chain.
Can 50 cents cross a border?	PayPal only, with a minimum cash-out	USDC goes to a wallet created at email sign-in. The platform pays the network fee.
Can a funder audit it?	A statement from the platform	Every payout is a public transaction, linked in the export.

The prototype today

Works on Solana devnet

- ✓ Escrow program: fund, pay out, close and refund
- ✓ Email sign-in that creates a wallet (Privy)
- ✓ Proof of human with World ID, one person per account
- ✓ One-time survey link, completion code, minimum time
- ✓ Results page and CSV export with a link per payout
- ✓ Network fees paid by the platform, not the participant

Not yet

Test network and test USDC only.

The human check is stored in our database. An on-chain attestation comes next.

External survey tools connect by a redirect link; tested with the built-in survey so far.

POTENTIAL MARKET

The market for human answers

WHOLE INDUSTRY

\$153bn

Global turnover of market research and insights in 2024, according to ESOMAR.

CLOSEST COMPARABLE

\$350M

Prolific's yearly revenue rate in April 2026, estimated by Sacra. It ran 380,000 studies and tasks in 2025.

HUMAN DATA FOR AI

\$17bn

Forecast for data collection and labelling in 2030, up from \$3.8bn in 2024 (Grand View Research).

Why now: Amazon closed Mechanical Turk on 30 September 2026. Researchers who recruited there need a new place.

THE ALTERNATIVE

ProofPanel next to Prolific

	Prolific	ProofPanel (prototype)
Platform fee	33.3% academic, 42.8% corporate	15% academic, 25% corporate (planned)
When pay arrives	After approval, by day 21 at the latest	Seconds after the last answer
How it arrives	PayPal only, from £6 or \$6	USDC to the participant's own wallet, any amount
Proof of a real person	Verification by the platform at sign-up	World ID proof; one person, one account
Who can join	Most OECD countries, with a waitlist	Open sign-up (test network today)

HOW IT MAKES MONEY

The business model

The researcher pays the rewards plus a platform fee when funding a study. Participants receive the full reward.

Customer	Our fee	Prolific
Academic and non-profit	15%	33.3%
Companies	25%	42.8%

Later: an API priced per verified answer.

Our cost per payout: a network fee of 0.000005 SOL, plus a deposit of about 0.0012 SOL per receipt that we plan to reclaim when a study closes.

Example study

200 people × \$3.00	\$600
Our fee at 15%	\$90
Researcher pays	\$690
Same study on Prolific	\$800

POTENTIAL TO GROW

First users and growth

NOW

Academic studies

Researchers who pay participants for surveys and experiments. We start with our own community at WHU.

NEXT

Product research

Startups that need user tests and interviews with verified people, paid per session.

LATER

Human answers API

AI labs and software agents buy verified human judgments through an API and pay per answer.

Why me: doctoral researcher at WHU, with direct access to the first users.

What carries over: one proof of being human and one wallet work for every kind of study.

The roadmap

STEP 1

Invisible crypto

- Researchers pay by card or invoice
- Participants cash out to a bank account
- Launch on mainnet with real USDC

STEP 2

Trust and quality

- Proof of human as an on-chain attestation
- Screening by country, language, profile
- Researcher review for unclear cases

STEP 3

Scale

- Connectors for common survey tools
- Receipt deposits reclaimed at study end
- API for AI labs and software agents

The goal of step 1: a researcher pays like on any website, a participant is paid like by any app, and neither has to know that Solana is underneath.

WHO AND WHERE

Founder and links



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Doctoral researcher in entrepreneurship and innovation at WHU

Master in Management at WHU

BSc in Business Information Systems, worked four years in IT

LIVE DEMO

<https://proofpanel.vercel.app/>

CODE

<https://github.com/fabN8/proofpanel>

CONTACT

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